Jihye Lee

Ph.D. Candidate, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis
Google Scholar | jihye.l@wustl.edu | jihyelee.org

EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis, Brown School, St. Louis, MO
Ph.D. Candidate in Social Work, 2023-*present*
Advisor: Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.

Dissertation	Beyond Access: Digitally Mediated Employment and Refugee Integration across Infrastructure, Practice, and Institutional Support in the United States
Committee	Drs. Mitra Naseh (Chair), Melissa Jonson-Reid, Patrick Fowler, Jin Huang, Stephen Roll

Chung-Ang University, School of Social Welfare, Seoul, Korea
Master of Social Welfare, 2021

Chung-Ang University, School of Social Welfare, Seoul, Korea
Bachelor of Arts in Social Welfare, 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Topics	Economic Self-Sufficiency; Immigration Policy and the Social Safety Net; Digital Inclusion and AI in Human Services
Populations	Immigrants; Refugees; Racially/Ethnically Minoritized Populations
Methods	Survey-Weighted Analysis; Computational Social Science (Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning, Network Analysis); Qualitative Methods (Reflexive Thematic Analysis, Phenomenological Interviews); Evidence Synthesis

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

16. **Lee, J**., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y., Bechara, S. & Hamilton, B. (2026). Multidimensional Poverty and Perceived Discrimination Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. *Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies.* 10.1080/15562948.2026.2670689

15. **Lee, J**., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. (2026). Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health, 28*(1), 78-88. 10.1007/s10903-025-01844-1

14. **Lee, J**., Naseh, M., Chen, J., Badiezadeh, S., Zamora Garcia, E. & Chow, C. (In Press). Liminal Legality and the Organization of DACA Scholarship: Keyword Co-occurrence Networks Across Presidential Administrations, 2013–2026. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*.

13. Yoo, N., **Lee, J**. & Jang, S. (2026). E-Government Engagement and Subjective Well-Being During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Comparing North Korean Refugees and Native Koreans. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies.* 10.1080/1369183X.2026.2706353

12. Zeng, Y., Naseh, M., **Lee, J**. & Bechara, S. (2026). From First Jobs to Better Pay: Predicting Refugee Wage Mobility with Machine Learning. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research.* 10.1086/740324

11. Ibrahim, H., Brugger, L., **Lee, J**. & Roll, S. (2026). Disproportionate Economic Hardships of COVID-19 on Immigrant Households. *Children and Youth Services Review.* 10.1016/j.childyouth.2026.109185

10. Da Luz Scherf, E., Naseh, M. & **Lee, J**. (2026). Migration Policies as Social Determinants of Health Among International Graduate Students in the United States. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health.* 10.1007/s10903-026-01948-2

9. Bechara, S., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y., **Lee, J**. & Baker, J. (2026). Afghan Refugees' Multidimensional Deprivation: Comparative Analysis of St. Louis, Portland, and a National Refugee Sample. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research.* 10.1086/742826

8. Naseh, M., Qushua, N., Nartey, P., **Lee, J**. & Razzak, R. B. (2026) A Scoping Review of Economic Integration Interventions and Programs for Refugees. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications.* 10.1057/s41599-026-07331-8

7. Taridashti, S., Naseh, M., Garcia, E. M. Z. & **Lee, J.** (2025). Health Impacts of Restrictive Migration Policies: A Qualitative Study of Highly Educated Iranian Immigrants and International Students in the U.S. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health,* 1-11. 10.1007/s10903-025-01760-4

6. Brugger, L., Bellisle, D., Maag, E., Udani, A., Roll, S., Hamilton, L. & **Lee, J**. (2025). Child tax credit utilization in immigrant households: a focus on child investment and college funds. *SN Business & Economics, 5*(9), 109. 10.1007/s43546-025-00871-2

5. Chung, Y., Maguire-Jack, K., Pei, F., **Lee, J.**, & Chang, Y (2025). The Mediating Role of Social Cohesion between Neighborhood Disorder and Child Maltreatment Behaviors across Childhood. *Journal of Family Violence,* 1-11. 10.1007/s10896-025-00988-w

4. Naseh, M., **Lee, J**., Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V. & Safi, M. (2024). Understanding Economic Integration in Immigrant and Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics in the United States. *Economies, 12*(7), 167. 10.3390/economies12070167

3. Chen, J., Jones, D., **Lee, J**., Yan, Y., Hsieh, W. J., Huang, C. H., ... & Drake, B. (2024). Do the benefits of homeownership on mental health vary by race and poverty status? An application of doubly robust estimation for causal inference. *Social Science & Medicine,* 116958. 10.1016/j.socscimed.2024.116958

2. Chang, Y., Maguire-Jack, K., Yoon, S. & **Lee, J**. (2022). Family-, school-, and neighborhood- level predictors of resilience for adolescents with a history of maltreatment. *Children*, 10(1). 10.3390/children10010001

1. **Lee, J**. & Moon, S. (2022). Analysis of Research Trends in Youth After-school Academy: Focusing on Keyword Network Analysis. *Social Science, 61*(2). 10.22418/JSS.2022.8.61.2.441

Working Papers and Policy Briefs

2. Naseh, M., **Lee, J**., & Bechara, S. (2026). *What drives refugees' high poverty in the early years after U.S.* resettlement? Migration Policy Institute. **[LINK] [LINK]**

1. Naseh, M., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y., **Lee, J**., & Potocky, M. (2026). Adaptation and Initial Validation of the U.S. Census Multidimensional Deprivation Index for Resettled Afghans (Working Paper No. 01). Forced Migration Initiative. 10.7936/f4tn-p468

Manuscripts Under Review

16. **Lee, J**., Bechara, S, Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Who Counts as Poor? Income, Employment, and Multidimensional Poverty Among Newly Resettled Refugee Households in the United States. *Journal of International Migration and Integration.* **[R&R]**
15. **Lee, J**., Dusard, L., Bechara, S. & Naseh, M. Enough for a Household? Individual wages and household poverty among newly resettled refugees in the United States. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*
14. **Lee, J**., Yoo, N., Bechara, S. Zeng, Y., & Naseh, M. From displacement to settlement: a scoping review of predictive AI in refugee and immigration services. *International Migration.*
13. **Lee, J**. & Yoo, N. Testing the social diversification hypothesis after resettlement: digital skill, social capital, and online economic activity among North Korean refugees and South Koreans. *Universal Access in the Information Society.*
12. **Lee, J**., Bechara, S, Zeng, Y. Haran, H., & Naseh, M. Getting by without getting ahead: low-barrier gig work and the early economic integration of newly resettled Afghans in the U.S. *Journal of Refugee Studies.*
11. Yoo, N., **Lee, J**. & Jang, S. Domain-specific patterns of perceived AI usefulness among North Korean refugees and native Koreans: A Latent Profile Analysis. *Journal of Psychology and AI.* **[R&R]**
10. Chow, C. & **Lee, J**. Policy models of immigrant political incorporation: conceptualization and empirical cases in Asian developed economies using fuzzy sets. *The Asian and Pacific Migration Journal.* **[R&R]**
9. Yoo, N. & **Lee, J**. Generative AI in immigration services: a scoping review of target users, access barriers, and governance reporting. *AI & SOCIETY*.
8. Yoo, N., **Lee, J**., Zhang, X. & Ki, D. Immigration and Visa Help-Seeking with General-Purpose AI Assistants. *Computer-Supported Cooperative Work Human-Computer Interaction*.
7. Yoo, N., **Lee, J**., Cureton, A. & Chow, C. Peer support and digital mutual aid among DACA recipients under liminal legality: a computational text analysis of Reddit community. *Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies.*
6. Yoo, N. & **Lee, J**. Learning Costs and Online Fraud among U.S. Immigrants: Duration of Residence, Language Preference, and the Stages of a Fraud Episode. *Journal of International Migration and Integration.*
5. Yoo, N., **Lee, J**., Min, S. & Kim, Y. Material hardship and livelihood coping strategies among refugees in South Korea. *Journal of Human Rights and Social Work*
4. Naseh, M., **Lee, J**. Badiezadeh, S. & Safi, H. Afghan refugees' conceptions of economic integration in the United States. *Journal of Sociology & Social Welfare.*

3. Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., **Lee, J**., Rafieifar, M. & Suarez, C. Social connectedness, integration, and quality of life among newly resettled Afghan refugee households in the United States. *SAGE Open.* **[R&R]**

2. Naseh, M., Bechara, S., Badiezadeh, S., **Lee, J**. & Baker, J. Structural barriers and facilitators in accessing employment for refugees in Missouri. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research.* **[R&R]**

1. Ilkkursun, Z., Bechara, S., Badiezadeh, S., **Lee, J**. & Naseh, M. Post-Resettlement Determinants of Mental Health Among Refugee Adolescents in Germany: A Secondary Social Ecological Analysis. *Child Indicators Research.* **[R&R]**

Works in Progress

2. Naseh, M., **Lee, J**. & Rafieifar, M. Uneven by programme: self-reported arrival status, SNAP and Medicaid receipt, and material hardship among Afghan arrivals in the United States

1. Lee, J., **Lee, J**. & Zhang, L. Federal and State Unemployment Insurance Policies and the Duration of Extended Benefits Availability During COVID-19.

FELLOWSHIPS AND COMPETITIVE PROGRAMS

Washington University in St. Louis, Clark-Fox Policy Institute, Graduate Policy Scholars Program, 2026–2027. Selected Scholar-in-Training for WashU-wide interdisciplinary training in policy practice and social justice across graduate and professional schools **[LINK]**

University of Michigan, Institute for Social Research, 2026 ISR Symposium on Complexity, "Place as Method, Theory, and Responsibility: Rethinking Scientific Inquiry for Complex Social Issues," Selected as one of 35 early-career scholars; full travel support provided. Ann Arbor, Michigan. October 7-9, 2026. **[LINK]**

Toronto Metropolitan University, Global Migration Institute, 2026 Global Migration Institute Winter School, "Digital technologies and migration studies: Impacts on governance, research methods, and ethics", Selected participant; partial program support awarded. Toronto, Canada. November 9-13, 2026. **[LINK]**

UC Davis, Global Migration Center, 2026 Summer School in the Economics of Migration, Mexico City, Mexico. July 20-24, 2026. **[LINK]**

Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity. Graduate Fellows Program - Race & Ethnicity Scholar ($4,000), 2025-2027. **[LINK]**

GRANTS AND AWARDS

External

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL), Displaced Livelihoods Initiative pilot proposal, June 2025-May 2026. **Role: PI**; co-PIs: Mitra Naseh, Patrick Fowler, and Zakira Hekmat. "Bridging Economic and Mental Health Support: A Community-Informed RCT for Afghan Refugees in Türkiye" ($50,000; **Finalist**; not funded).

Internal

Global Programs, Brown School. Global Programs Fund ($1,000), May 2026.

Global Programs, Brown School. Khinduka Global Professional Development Fund ($1,000), November 2025.

CFU Graduate Professional Student Council. Second Place in Social Science, 30th Annual Graduate Research Symposium ($150), March 2025. **[LINK] [LINK]**

Center for Human Rights, Gender and Migration. 2024 Seed Grant ($2,500), June 2024-June 2025. **Role: PI**; co-PI: Mitra Naseh. "Quality of Life of Highly Educated Iranian Immigrants and Restrictive Migration Policies." **[LINK]**

Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity. Graduate Student Conference Travel Award ($750), October 2024. **[LINK]**

Global Programs, Brown School. Global Programs Pilot Research Fund ($2,500), February-June 2024. **Role: PI**; co-PI: Mitra Naseh. "Breaking Barriers: Unraveling the Impact of Financial Aid Policies on Social Mobility for DACA Recipients." **[LINK]**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Immigrant Wellbeing and Technology Lab, University of Michigan, 2026-*present*. PI: Nari Yoo, Ph.D.

Research Assistant, Forced Migration Initiative, Washington University in St. Louis, 2023-*present*. PI: Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.
Social position and administrative barriers in the multidimensional economic integration of newly resettled Afghans **[LINK]**; Economic integration of newly resettled Afghans **[LINK]**; Ethnic networks and health disparities among Afghan refugees **[LINK]**; and Restrictive migration policies and the well-being of highly educated immigrants **[LINK]**

Research Assistant, Children, Families, & Policy Lab, University of Georgia, 2025-*present*. PI: Liwei Zhang, Ph.D.
Supported by the *Eunice Kennedy Shriver* National Institute of Child Health and Human Development (K01HD110683).

Research Assistant, Center for Innovation in Child Maltreatment Policy, Research and Training, Washington University in St. Louis, 2023-2025. PI: Melissa Jonson-Reid, Ph.D.
Contributed to the Scientific Learning Collaborative Dynamic Evidence Map (system dynamics mapping of child maltreatment evidence).

Research Assistant, Child Maltreatment Prevention Lab, University of Michigan, 2022-2023. PI: Kathryn Maguire-Jack, Ph.D.

Research Assistant, Division of Social Cohesion Research, Korea Institute for Public Administration, 2018-2023. PI: Dongjae Jung, Ph.D.
Contributed to the execution and publication of eight government-commissioned academic papers related to refugees and undocumented and immigrant households/workers in Korea.

Editorial Research Assistant, Journal of the Korean Council for Children's Rights, 2021-2023.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

***Co-Instructor**,* Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Spring 2026. "*Evaluation of Programs and Services*" (Online, S50-6001) [MSW].

***Teaching Assistant**,* Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2026. "*Social Welfare Policies & Services*" (S15-4100) [MSW].

***Teaching Assistant**,* Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2024. "*Social Work Practice with Refugees and Immigrants*" (S31-5007) [MSW].

***Teaching Assistant**,* Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Summer 2024. "*Evaluation of Program and Services*" (Online, S50-5050) [MSW].

***Teaching Assistant**,* Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Spring 2024. "*Policy and Service for Children and Youth*" (S40-5771) [MSW].

***Guest Lecturer**,* "Immigration Today [BA]" University of Wisconsin Whitewater, Fall 2026.

***Guest Lecturer**,* "*English Language Programs* [MSW/MPH]", Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2025

***Guest Lecturer**,* "*Human Behavior and the Social Environment* [BA]", Chung-Ang University, Spring 2024.

***Grading Assistant**,* East Asian Languages and Cultures, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2024-Spring 2025. "*Basic Korean, Korean I, and Korean II.*"

FIELD EXPERIENCE

Post-MSW Practice Experience

Social Worker, Sungji Child Welfare Center, Busan, Korea, Aug 2021-Jul 2023. Conducted needs assessments and case-management interviews with children in low-income families, including families with immigrant parents; coordinated referrals to community resources such as after-school and tutoring programs and public assistance.

Pre-MSW Practice Experience

Social Work Practicum, Chung-Ang University Social Welfare Center, Seoul, Korea, Mar-Jun 2018 (160 hours). Assisted in linking clients to community resources, including food banks and academies.

Social Work Practicum, Moon-Chon 7 Social Welfare Center, Gyeonggi-do, Korea, Jul-Oct 2017 (160 hours). Supported case management and program-effectiveness assessment for children.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Community Presentations

Lee, J., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y., & Naseh, M. Multidimensional Poverty Among Newly Resettled Refugees in the U.S., Evidence from the Annual Survey of Refugees [Oral Presentation]. Community Hearing Session. Clark-Fox Policy Institute, St. Louis, MO. April 1, 2026 **[LINK] [LINK]**

Naseh, M., **Lee, J**., Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V & Safi, M. Measuring Economic Integration Among Immigrants and Refugees in the US: A Scoping Review [Oral Presentation]. Immigrant Service Provider Network (ISPN). St. Louis, MO. December 8, 2023.

Conference Presentations

Lee, J. & Yoo, N. A Larger Payoff for the Resettled: Digital Skill, Social Capital, and Economic Participation among North Korean Refugees and Native South Koreans [Oral Presentation]. IMISCOE. *Studying Migration in the Digital Era: Innovation, Regulation, Ethics, and Rights*. Toronto, Canada. March 10-12, 2027.

Lee, J., Yoo, N., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Between Protection and Control: A Scoping Review of Artificial Intelligence Applications and Ethical Governance in Refugee and Immigrant Services [Poster]. SSWR. San Francisco, CA. January 20–24, 2027.

Lee, J., Bechara, S, Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Multidimensional Poverty among newly resettled refugees in the U.S., evidence from 2019-2021. [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Boston, MA. November 5–7, 2026

Lee, J., Yoo, N., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Refugee and Immigrant Support: A Scoping Review [Oral Presentation]. CERC in Migration and Integration. Toronto, Canada. April 15-17, 2026

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. [Poster]. SSWR. Washington, DC. January 14–18, 2026

Yoo, N., **Lee, J**., Cureton, A. & Chow, C. Digital Mutual Aid in Precarity: Peer Support Among DACA Recipients on Reddit Across U.S. Administrations [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y. & Bechara, S. Multidimensional Deprivation and Discrimination Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Ilkkursun, Z., Acarturk, C., Soylu, N. & Sohtorik Ilkmen, Y. From Policy Shifts to Lived Health Realities: A Phenomenological Study of Afghan Refugees in Türkiye. [Oral Presentation]. Global Health at WashU: Focus on Impact. St. Louis, MO. May 1, 2025.

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Bechara, S. & Zeng, Y. Multidimensional Deprivation Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. [Oral Presentation]. Graduate Research Symposium. St. Louis, MO. March 27, 2025.

Naseh, M., **Lee, J**., Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P. & Alvarez, V. Understanding Economic Integration Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics [Oral Presentation]. In Conceptualizing Success and Integration Among Refugees: Perspectives from Research and Practice (Panel). IASFM20: Forced Displacement in an Urbanizing World: Yogyakarta, Indonesia. January 21–23, 2025.

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Brugger, L. & Alvarez V. Towards Integration: Unpacking the Complexities of Multidimensional Economic Integration of Refugees in the U.S. [Oral Presentation]. In Conceptualizing Success and Integration Among Refugees: Perspectives from Research and Practice (Panel). IASFM20: Forced Displacement in an Urbanizing World: Yogyakarta, Indonesia. January 21–23, 2025.

Naseh, M., **Lee, J**., Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V. & Safi, M. Understanding Economic Integration in Immigrant and Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics in the United States [Oral Presentation]. SSWR. Seattle, WA. January 15-19, 2025.

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S. & Zamora Garcia, E. Pathways to Economic Integration: A Social Network Analysis of Multidimensional Barriers Faced by DACA Recipients [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. National Harbor, MD. November 21 - 23, 2024

Lee, J. Exploring Research Trends in Korea's after-School Academy Policy for Youth Using Keyword Network Analysis. [Oral Presentation]. SSWR. Washington, DC. January 10-14, 2024.

Naseh, M., **Lee, J**., Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V. & Safi, M. Measuring Economic Integration Among Immigrants and Refugees in the US: A Scoping Review [Oral Presentation]. SSWR. Washington, DC. January 10-14, 2024.

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad Hoc Peer Reviewer

International Migration (2026); Journal of Human Rights and Social Work (2026); Journal of International Migration and Integration (2026); Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research (2026); Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health (2026); Journal of Public Health Policy (2026); Archives of Public Health (2025).

Community and Volunteer Service

Korean Language and Culture Mentor for Korean Americans, June 2025-*present*. Provide weekly one-on-one Zoom mentoring focused on Korean language acquisition, cultural knowledge, and identity exploration.

Volunteer, Welcome Neighbor STL, September 2024. Supported a newly resettled Afghan refugee family in St. Louis through a family visit conducted with the Social Work Practice with Refugees and Immigrants course.

Fundraising Volunteer, Busan, Korea, July-November 2021. Raised $12,940 from 526 sponsors across three projects supporting immigrant families and low-literacy older adults.

MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

IASFM20 Podcast, June 2025. Featured in a conversation with Mitra Naseh and Akino Tahir about the economic integration of resettled refugees in the United States and the importance of multidimensional approaches beyond employment. **[LINK]**

STUDENT RESEARCH MENTORING

Laura Villegas, Doctoral Student, University of Georgia, 2026-*present*
Jason Tang, Undergraduate Student, Washington University in St. Louis, 2026

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS AND AFFILIATIONS

Professional Associations

International Association for the Study of Forced Migration, 2025-*present*
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, 2023-*present*
Society for Social Work and Research, 2022-*present*

Research Networks and Affiliations

IMISCOE: International Migration Research Network, 2026-*present*
UC Berkeley Interdisciplinary Migration Initiative, 2026-*present*
Social Work AI Network, 2026-*present*
Grand Challenges for Social Work: Immigration Working Group, 2026-*present*
Canada Excellence Research Chair (CERC) in Migration and Integration, 2026-*present*
Data Science & Artificial Intelligence (Special Interest Group) [SSWR], 2026-*present*
Korean American Social Work Educators Association, 2024-*present*
Refugee & Immigrant SIG (Special Interest Group) [SSWR], 2024-*present*
Immigrant Service Provider Network, St. Louis, 2024-*present*
Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity, Graduate Student Affiliate, 2024-*present*

Professional License

Licensed Social Worker II, Korean Social Worker's Association, 2020